



ARRO INNOVATION FOUNDATION (AIF)

AIF Inspire & AIF Ignite

OFFICIAL GUIDELINES & RULE BOOK

AIF IS THE FOUNDATION OF ARRO'S INNOVATION MISSION.

ARRO Innovation Foundation (AIF) is the innovation-focused foundation of ARRO. AIF provides the framework through which young innovators can present ideas, receive guidance, gain recognition, and compete through two dedicated competitions: AIF Inspire and AIF Ignite.

IDEAS • INNOVATION • IMPACT

This rule book establishes the participation, submission, evaluation, selection, recognition, guidance and opportunity framework for AIF Inspire and AIF Ignite.

Document edition: AIF Official Rule Book

Issued by: ARRO Innovation Foundation (AIF)

1. Eligibility

- **Eligible participants:** School students from Playgroup through Class 12.
- **School:** Students from any school may participate.
- **Participation format:** Individual participation and team participation are permitted.
- **Team size:** A team may contain a maximum of **9 members**.
- **Annual submission limit:** One participant may submit a minimum of **3** and a maximum of **6 innovations per year**.
- **Track restriction:** Each innovation may be submitted to **only one** competition—AIF Inspire or AIF Ignite.

AIF may verify participant and team information during screening or at any later stage where verification is necessary.

2. Submission Rules

- Every submission must contain an **idea synopsis** explaining the innovation.
- The participant/team must explain **why the innovation was made** and what problem, need or opportunity it addresses.
- A physical prototype/model is **optional**. A participant may instead provide a clear drawing/design of the proposed innovation.
- The submission should identify the major **components, materials or systems** required.
- If a development board or programmable hardware is used, the relevant **code should be included**.
- AI tools may be used to assist with **coding and writing the synopsis**. However, the underlying innovation, concept and thinking must be the participant's own.
- Existing inventions may be improved. Such improvements are eligible for **AIF Inspire**. An improved existing invention may enter **AIF Ignite only when AIF determines that the improvement contains a genuinely distinctive/groundbreaking innovation**.
- Submissions must be understandable, truthful and sufficiently detailed for judges to evaluate the idea.

Original thinking is a core requirement. Using AI as a support tool does not transfer ownership of the innovation to the AI tool.

3. AIF Inspire / AIF Ignite Definitions

Competition	Definition	Eligibility Focus
AIF Inspire	A competition designed to encourage innovation that can inspire, help people, solve a problem, create value, or introduce a meaningful new idea.	Any category of innovation, provided it satisfies AIF's originality and submission requirements.
AIF Ignite	A higher-difficulty competition intended to ignite the fire of innovation for humanity, the environment, or groundbreaking advancement.	Human safety, environmental safety, or genuinely groundbreaking innovation. AIF determines whether an idea meets the Ignite threshold.

Important: AIF Ignite is intentionally more difficult to enter. A submission is not placed in Ignite merely because it is technically advanced; it must satisfy the stated impact/innovation focus.

4. Judging Criteria

Judges evaluate submissions using the following core dimensions:

Criterion	What judges consider
Innovation / Originality	Novel thinking, originality, creativity, and how clearly the idea differs from existing solutions.
Real-world Usefulness	Whether the innovation addresses a genuine need or has a practical use.
Technical Quality	Technical reasoning, design quality, components, implementation, code where relevant, and understanding of how the system works.
Impact	Potential benefit to people, communities, humanity, the environment, or the relevant problem area.
Submission Quality	Clarity, completeness, explanation of why it was made, drawings/model/code/components where applicable, and ability to communicate the concept.

5. Selection Process

The AIF competition follows a staged selection process:

Stage	Process
1	Submission and initial review
2	Round 1 judging
3	Up to 9 finalists selected for the final stage
4	Finalist Q&A; session
5	Final judging
6	One winner selected for each competition

The stated finalist count and dates may be adjusted by AIF where necessary. Any change will be communicated through official ARRO/AIF channels.

6. ■1,000 Prize Rules

- There will be **one prize winner per competition**: one AIF Inspire winner and one AIF Ignite winner, subject to the competition being held and final selection.
- The stated prize is **■1,000 for the winner** of each competition.
- The **■1,000 cash prize is subject to ARRO's monthly revenue condition**: if ARRO's monthly revenue is below **■10,000**, the cash prize will not be paid for that competition and the winner will receive the applicable recognition/certificate instead.
- AIF may communicate the final prize status to finalists/winners when results are announced.
- Certificates and recognition are separate from the cash-prize condition.

7. Number of Winners

- **AIF Inspire**: One winner.
- **AIF Ignite**: One winner.
- Other finalists and eligible participants receive the certificates/recognition applicable to their stage.

- AIF may provide special recognition for exceptional innovations even when they are not the final winner.

8. Timeline

Milestone	Planned date	Note
Registration opens	21 March	Annual schedule
Submission deadline	18 April	Submissions must be received by the announced deadline.
Round 1 result	6 May	Initial selection result
Finalist Q&A;	9 May	Q&A; for selected finalists
Finalist/final stage	12 May	May vary if required by AIF

These dates are the planned annual schedule and may vary. The latest official AIF announcement takes precedence.

9. Mentor & Guidance System

AIF is intended to provide participants with meaningful guidance rather than only competition results.

- Guidance may be provided by **ARRO members** and, where available, relevant experts/professionals.
- Guidance may cover idea development, technical reasoning, prototype planning, presentation, documentation and improvement.
- The exact form and availability of mentoring may vary according to the innovation and available ARRO resources.
- Mentoring does not guarantee selection, winning, funding, employment or membership in ARRO.

10. What “Work with ARRO” Means

Outstanding participants may be considered for opportunities to:

- Receive an **internship/project opportunity**, where available.
- Join or collaborate on an **ARRO project**.
- Become an **ARRO contributor**.
- Collaborate with ARRO on innovation or development work.
- Take part in other suitable innovation opportunities offered by ARRO.

An AIF award or finalist position does not automatically guarantee an ARRO role. Opportunities are subject to suitability, availability, project needs, participant age/school requirements, and ARRO's applicable rules.

11. Certificate & Acknowledgment Policy

- **Automatic acknowledgment letter:** After successful registration, AIF will provide an acknowledgment letter automatically through the ARRO website system.
- **Participation certificate:** Issued to eligible participants according to AIF's participation requirements.
- **Finalist certificate:** Issued to participants selected for the finalist stage.
- **Winner certificate:** Issued to the winner of each competition.
- **Special recognition:** Exceptional innovations may receive special recognition on the ARRO website.
- Finalists and winners may also receive public recognition through official ARRO/AIF channels.

12. Originality, Conduct & Integrity

- Participants must submit their own innovation thinking and must not knowingly copy another participant's work.
- AI assistance for coding or synopsis writing is permitted, but participants remain responsible for understanding, explaining and owning their innovation concept.
- AIF may request clarification, supporting evidence, a demonstration, code, drawings, or other material where necessary.
- Misrepresentation, plagiarism, fabricated claims, or materially misleading information may lead to disqualification or withdrawal of recognition.
- AIF's screening and judging decisions are made for the purpose of administering the competition and may consider the information available at the time of review.

13. Administration & Official Communication

- AIF is the innovation foundation/pillar of ARRO and administers the AIF Inspire and AIF Ignite competitions.
- Official dates, submission instructions, announcements and changes will be communicated through official ARRO/AIF channels.
- AIF may update operational details when necessary for fair and practical administration, while communicating material changes to participants.
- Where a rule requires interpretation, AIF may determine how the rule applies to a particular submission.

AIF — INSPIRE THE IDEA. IGNITE THE INNOVATOR.

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